

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

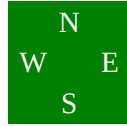
♠ 9 7 5 2
 ♥ 8 2
 ♦ T 7 6 4 3
 ♣ K 7

♠ A T 4

♥ J 6 3

♦ A K 8 2

♣ Q T 5



♠ J 8 3

♥ A K 9 7 5

♦ Q 9 5

♣ 6 3

♠ K Q 6

♥ Q T 4

♦ J

♣ A J 9 8 4 2

West

North

East

South

1♦

1♥

2♣

Pass

3♣

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

establish ♣s. He will enter dummy with the ♠A, then try to run the ♣Q.

[showcards W:H8]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥8, dummy played the ♥J

Play the ♥9. South played dummy's ♥J to tempt you to cover. Don't fall for it.

Partner's lead of a high spot card shows no honors in the suit. That added to the fact that South bid Notrump after you had mentioned ♥s is pretty good evidence that South holds at least ♥Q x x.

To maintain communication with partner your best hope is to duck the first ♥, but to signal encouragement with the ♥9.

South wins the first trick easily, but must try to

Not today. Partner takes the ♣K and returns his ♥2 to your four winners.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 6 2
 ♥ T 6 4
 ♦ A J 6 5 4
 ♣ 9 2

♠ Q J 9 3

♥ K Q J 5

♦ 9 3

♣ Q J T



♠ 8 4

♥ 9 7 3

♦ T 8 7 2

♣ A 6 5 3

♠ A T 7 5

♥ A 8 2

♦ K Q

♣ K 8 7 4

West	North	East	South
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Pass	2♣	Pass	1NT
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Pass	4♠		2♠
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All Pass

4♠ by South
 opened 1NT with either 5-4-2-2 or 5-4-3-1 distribution.

[showcards W:C9]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♣9,
 dummy played the ♣T

Play the ♣6.

Partner's ♣9 is likely from a short suit. If it is a singleton, you should take the ♣A immediately and return the suit for a ruff. If it is a doubleton, you should NOT take your ♣A now, but should hope partner can get the lead and play his second ♣ to your Ace so you can give him the ruff.

You can figure out which it is.

If it is a singleton, then South must hold 5 ♣s. But you know South has 4 ♠s, so if he also has 5 ♣s then he only has 4 red cards, and he would not have

So partner's ♣9 is not a singleton, and you should wait. Declarer then runs dummy's ♠Q. Partner wins the ♠K, returns his OTHER ♣ to your ♣A, and NOW you give him the ruff. He takes the ♦A for down 1.

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ T 8 3

♥ T 2

♦ Q J 8 6 4 2

♣ 8 3

♠ 6 5 2

♥ J 9 8

♦ 9 5

♣ K J T 9 7



♠ Q J 9 7

♥ K Q 6 5 3

♦ T

♣ A 6 4

♠ A K 4

♥ A 7 4

♦ A K 7 3

♣ Q 5 2

West	North	East	South
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Pass	2♣	Pass	2NT
------	----	------	-----

Pass	3NT		
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All Pass

3NT by South

♥s to enter dummy and he will never get to enjoy those two ♣ winners.

[showcards W:HT]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥10, dummy played the ♥J

Play the ♥6.

Declarer gets two ♥ winners whether you play one of your honors on this trick or not. So why does it matter what you do?

Suppose you cover with your ♥Q. South will win his ♥A, then play ♣s until your ♣A is forced out on the third round. He can then force an entry to dummy in the ♥ suit to reach the two ♣ winners.

Now suppose you duck the ♥J. Again South will push ♣s, and again you hold up until the third round. Ahh, what a difference. Now declarer cannot use the

Board 4

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q
 ♥ T 9 6 5 2
 ♦ J 8 6 3
 ♣ 6 4 2

♠ 7 5 4 2

♥ K Q

♦ A 5

♣ K J T 8 5

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♠ A J 3

♥ A J 3

♦ K T 9 2

♣ 9 7 3

♠ K T 9 8 6

♥ 8 7 4

♦ Q 7 4

♣ A Q

West	North	East	South
	1♣	1♠	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South

The contract could no longer be beaten.

[showcards W:SQ]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠Q, a low card was played from dummy,

Play the ♠K.

It seems that perhaps you should play low and let partner's ♠Q force out South's ♠A. Then, when you get the lead with a high ♣ you can force out South's ♠J. Get the lead with your other high ♣ and set the contract with ♠s.

Suppose you try that. Play low on the first ♠. South will also play low and West will be left holding the trick, and also holding the bag! With no more ♠s West will have to play one of the other three suits, and that is just what South wants to have happen.

Now do it the right way. Play your ♠K on partner's ♠Q. Assume South takes the trick, although it doesn't matter whether he wins the first one or holds up. When you win your first ♣ drive out South's ♠J. When you win your second ♣ trick your ♠s will be good. If you overtake the first trick the contract can no longer be made.

Notice that South will always make two ♠ tricks, so your overtake costs nothing.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 3
 ♥ J 8 6 5 2
 ♦ J T 9 4
 ♣ K 4

♠ A 6
 ♥ K 9 3
 ♦ Q 6 2
 ♣ Q J 9 8 2



♠ K 8 7 5 4 2
 ♥ Q T 4
 ♦ 8 3
 ♣ A 6

♠ Q J T
 ♥ A 7
 ♦ A K 7 5
 ♣ T 7 5 3

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	2 ♠	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South

West (your wonderful partner) will win the first ♣ and return his final ♠ to dummy's ♠A.

South will have to keep working on ♣s, but now you can win the ♣A and play your ♠K, dropping South's ♠Q, and your other three good ♠s.

Just like the previous deal, South gets two ♠ tricks either way, but one way he makes an overtrick, the other way he goes down 2.

[showcards W:S9]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠9, dummy played the ♠6

Play the ♠8 (to signal encouragement).

You could easily win the ♠K, then play a small ♠ to drive out dummy's ♠A. But South bid Notrump over your 2 ♠ overcall, so he surely holds ♠ Q J 10. So when you get the lead with your one ♣A entry you can establish your ♠s, but you won't get into the lead to cash them.

Look what happens when you duck the first trick. South will win the trick with his ♠T, and start on dummy's ♣ suit.

Board 6

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q 8 3

♥ 6

♦ J T 7 2

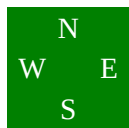
♣ K Q J T

♠ J T 6 4

♥ Q J T

♦ A K 6

♣ 9 4 2



♠ 7 2

♥ 8 4 3

♦ 9 5 4

♣ A 8 7 5 3

♠ K 9 5

♥ A K 9 7 5 2

♦ Q 8 3

♣ 6

West

North

East

South

Dbl

Rdbl

2♣

Pass

3♣

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

next two ♠s, then leads a third ♠ for you to ruff. Down 1.

[showcards W:CK]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♣K, dummy played low

Overtake partner's ♣K with the ♣A.

You are pretty sure partner would not have supported your ♣s unless he had 4 of them, which means it is very likely that South has a singleton. (he might even be void)

So if you are to set this contract partner is going to have to have some ♠ winners. It might not matter, but it also might be vital that the first ♠ lead comes from your side of the table so after you overtake with the ♣A you switch to the ♠7.

Partner loves it - whatever South does West takes the